



Opera launches Neon

Opera Neon is a new experimental desktop browser with bubble icons replacing your taskbar and bookmarks bar. <http://dgit.in/OperaNeon>



HTC U and U ultra

HTC's new U flagship phone has two screens, an ultrapixel camera and a new AI assistant preloaded. <http://dgit.in/HTCUltra>



FRBs have been detected to be originating not just from the Milky Way but from across the universe

the Milky Way since the rest of them originated from our galaxy itself. The reason why these particular FRBs are being discussed as a possible extra-terrestrial attempt is the repetitive nature of the signal. In fact, the signals could be emitted from new-born stars with huge magnetic fields (magnetars), supernova remnants, or in fact aliens trying to contact us. Recently, a team of researchers from McGill University in Canada discovered (read here: <http://dgit.in/FRB121102>) six more such radio bursts originating from the same source, bringing the total to 17. Five of the latest signals were detected with the Green Bank Telescope at 2GHz, and one at 1.5GHz with the Arecibo Observatory. The current hypothesis for the source of the FRBs originating from the Milky Way is the short-lived radio energy emitted during the collision of two neutron stars that results in the formation of a black hole. But since the radio bursts in FRB 121102 have displayed a repetitive pattern, the current hypothesis doesn't hold. Instead, the new hypothesis suggests a newly formed neutron star rotating with enough power to emit strong pulses at intervals.

A pair of astronomers Ermanno Borra and Eric Trottier from Laval University published a paper in Oct 2016 (read here: <http://dgit.in/234Signals>), covering the analysis of 2.5 Million stars present in the Sloan Digital Sky Survey trying to detect spectral modulations and observe whether they follow a particular pattern. The research men-

tioned mysterious signals coming from 234 stars that can have origins from an extra-terrestrial intelligent civilisations. Just like the Wow! Signal, the theory

suggests that aliens sending these signals is one of the possibilities being considered and not the only one.

This implies that we are definitely improving on discovering or getting as close as we can to determining the point of origin of these signals. It's also clear

that we are a long way from determining what these bursts are and what's creating them. For now, efforts are being made to detect more of such FRBs, no matter where they are originating

The Wow! Reply message included 10,000 Tweets with the hashtag #ChasingUFOs, and videos from celebrities such as comedian Stephen Colbert.



Neutron stars emit high energy radio waves often mistaken as fast radio bursts

from, and study them. As research is conducted on a wider dataset, we might soon be able to accurately pinpoint the source and even determine what caused them. And maybe, just maybe, if extra-terrestrials are trying make contact, we would one day be able to establish communication.

Sending a message

Along with searching for a technologically advanced civilisation in the universe, it's also essential to broadcast messages. Active SETI have undertaken numerous projects targeted at stars between 17 and 69 light years away from Earth. Among the most notable projects, the Arecibo message was sent in 1974 to the globular cluster M13 which approximately 24,000 light years away and the main intention behind sending this message was to test newly installed equipment. Another important message is RuBisCo Stars sent in 2009 which will be the first message to reach its destination – Teegarden's star – in 2021. It would have been a shame if we left the Wow! Signal unanswered even if it wasn't a message in the first place. The Wow! Reply was sent in 2012 celebrating the 35th anniversary of the Wow! Signal and the launch of National Geographic Channel's new show "Chasing UFOs".

Several critics have been against the idea of sending a transmission since it will give away the location of Earth. Although it's a genuine concern, many have argued that the advantages of establishing communication with extra-terrestrials far outweigh the dangers.



Arecibo and RuBisCo Stars messages were transmitted from the Arecibo Observatory

Returning back to the title or rather question of this entire article. Is there anybody out there? Probably. We have already witnessed a jump in technology in detecting signals and observing deep space. One of those FRBs might turn out to be from an extra-terrestrial civilisation and perhaps we make contact. 